

Q.3b (15 marks): How does qualitative and quantitative methods supplement each other in Anthropological research?

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Quantitative and qualitative methods for data collection and analysis form the basis to reinforcing the interpretations of studies.

	Quantitative	Qualitative
Methods	- Census - Anthropometric measure	- Interview - Participant observation - Case studies
Analysis	- Descriptive - Interpretive - Time Series	- Content Analysis - Grounded Analysis.

Both methods supplement each other in anthropological research as: —

① Quantitative data builds background for qualitative analysis in society for understanding social variables

Case study: AM Shah used quantitative census data to understand the pre and 1980 data on no. of joint RadhaGANJ village. Then post qualitative study of society began understanding of domestic groups and how ~~the~~ nuclear families and joint families exist today.

② Qualitative inferences ensure that a rational, scientific methodology is found for understanding any phenomena.

Case Study → • Racism was a ~~social~~ ^{biological} construct.
 • Earlier said to be biological based on qualitative data like skin colour.
 • Later genetics like HGT Project show 99.9% humans have same genes → So race is social.

③ They help in making research holistic.
 (eg. Chagnon) study of Yanomamo collected data on age, settlements size etc based on which inferences on kinship, economy drawn.

④ Inter-disciplinary research happens when multiple types of data collected.
 (eg. Census, sampling data to ~~rather~~ ensure that same data in other fields [sociology] etc ⇒ More inferences can be drawn.

Challenges in collection of data for anthropology

Quantitative data:

- ① Methodologies and techniques that are based on objective processes (eg) Sheldon's growth studies based on photographs rejected.
- ② Privacy of data (eg) Collection of census data and protecting confidentiality.

Qualitative data:

- ① challenges in building rapport (eg) Mead got incorrect data from informant
- ② challenges of language with locals
- ③ Ensuring data is not used for generalizing without detailed studies (eg) Evolutionary studies.

Quantitative and qualitative data in anthropology help in holistic culture studies and tools like Anthropac today are combining both for better understanding.